

RED FACTION

Code Red

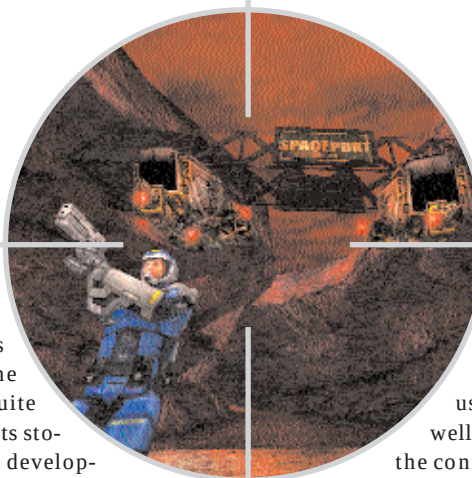
There are several ways to approach a single player FPS. *Doom* and *Serious Sam* downplayed story and let you kill enemies by the hordes, while *Half-Life* and *No One Lives Forever* are held by a strong storyline. Volition, the minds behind the *Descent* game series tread another path—by destroying terrains. The most hyped part of the game is the Geo Mod Technology, that lets players blow up objects—walls, ceilings, wooden structures. Players can actually deform the terrain and create improvised 'steps' out of huge rock piles. This lets you interact with the world in a way that has never been done before in an FPS.

The basic premise behind the game is pretty simple. It follows Parker, a miner employed by an oppressive firm called Ultor, on Mars. The goal is to stay alive long enough to bring down Ultor and solve the mystery of the plague which has been affecting all the miners. This journey takes him from gritty subterranean mines to Ultor's pristine science and nanotech labs

to the surface of Mars and even onto satellites orbiting high above the planet.

The interaction with the characters is quite low and the game never quite immerses you with its storyline. Character development is non-existent—at certain points there's no clear motive as to why Parker needs to mindlessly kill everything in sight. What wins you over is the enemy AI, some refreshing weapons, combined with a pace that will keep you obsessed. *Red Faction* has an arsenal of 15 weapons that you, as the player, can carry around; almost all weapons have an alternate fire mode. The selection of weapons range from the obvious handgun/pistol to the BFG inspired Fusion Rocket Launcher.

The graphics appear a little dated. Games such as *Quake III* and *Max Payne*



look better than *Red Faction*, probably because Volition spent more time working on deformable terrain than anything else.

Vehicles are fun to use and they handle well, but are pointless in the context of the game. The

single player game is a tad brief, a trend seen increasingly in today's games. Like the vast majority of FPS games, *Red Faction* features free multiplayer out of the box. All in all, an above average game that does everything FPSs are supposed to do, and a little more.

Genre: FPS/Action

Developer: Volition, Inc

Contact: Express Interactive

Phone: 022-8870017/8850245

Web site: www.redfaction.com

Price: Rs 699

Rating: ★★★★★

DOOM: COLLECTOR'S EDITION

One for the connoisseur

The story goes that the name 'Doom' sprang from the effect Carmack envisioned it would have on the game industry. And it did turn out to be true, in a manner of speaking. *Doom* has changed the way we look at action games—death-match, mods and multiplayer have become the norm. The graphics, sounds and level conception was revolutionary. The mood of the game was violent, the action frenetic, and gamers lapped it up. The success of *Doom* spawned several clones. Almost every game that followed stuck with some of the concepts that this game created.

The game took *Wolfenstein 3D*'s

technology and upped the ante. Texture mapped floors and ceilings were introduced, along with multiple elevations to create much more realistic worlds. The enemies were more plentiful and better animated, the weapons were much more diverse and used different types of ammunition and did varying amounts of damage. The game had varied levels of brightness to make certain areas more dark and moody than others. There were also multitudes of enemies which were far more diverse; they each had their own weapon. All of these features were inspiring to say the least, to the industry.



But that was a long time ago. Almost a decade. A little too old to be hip with the GeForce generation. Unless you're a FPS enthusiast who wants a personal copy of one of the most formative 3D games of the action genre.

This collector's edition brings *Doom*, *The Ultimate Doom*, and *The Final Doom* together in a single pack. An all-in-one CD, in a DVD case. The price is a little on the steep side for a classic game, considering that newer games sell at the same price. But for those who want a piece of the old nostalgia, this pack will bring back sweet memories. It shall also keep you busy until id revives the *Doom* franchise with their upcoming *Doom III*.

Genre: Action

Contact: Milestone Interactive

Developer: id Software

Phone: 022-8381614

Web site: www.idsoftware.com

Price: Rs 699

Rating: ★★★★★